

KF Reading Guide

Chapter 5: *Self-Hate and Self-Contempt*¹

1. When we shift our center of gravity to the idealized self, what does the glorified self become? (110.2)
2. When the human being which we actually are interferes with our flight to glory, what are we bound to do? (110.2)
3. The drive to become a splendid being is doomed to failure, but what at best may neurotics be able to do? (111.2)
4. Who are the two persons involved in the neurotic's conflict? (111.3)
 - A.
 - B.
5. What is the essential characteristic of every neurotic? (112.2)
6. What happens when the pride system starts to totter and a person becomes closer to the real self? (112.3)
7. What is the "central inner conflict"? (113.1)
8. What is the real self, with its capacity for growth, doing in the midst of this inner conflict? (113.1)
9. Why do we hate ourselves? (114.2)
10. Before neurotics can set going a constructive move, what must they feel? (115.2)

11. Drawing on Horney's examples and your own experience, what are the results of self-hate? (116.2)

12. From your own experience, what sins against your self could be blurred by pride? (116.2)

13. Horney roughly distinguishes between what two forms of externalized self-hate? (116.3)

A.

B.

14. What are the six modes of operation in, or expressions of, self-hate? (117.4)

A.

B.

C.

D.

E.

F.

15. What seems to be the whole point of self-hate? (118.1)

16. Do you recognize any of these or other shoulds within your own neurotic system? (118.3–120.2)

17. What is the first striking factor of a person on the verge of realization? (121.2-3)
18. What are two self-deceptive measures that the neurotic takes? (122.4–123.1)
- A.
- B.
19. What is another expression of self-hate? (123.5)
20. What is a more productive response to our neurotic affliction? (125.1)
21. What may seem to be the very image of conscientious scrutiny? (125.3)
22. What are the two self-protective measures that ward off severe self-recrimination? (128.1)
- A.
- B.
23. Self-accusations about actions and attitudes which, viewed objectively, seem harmless, legitimate, or even desirable often concern what? (130.2)
24. Which of these or other examples of self-accusation do you recognize in your own life? (130.2)
25. What stunts the capacity for constructive self-criticism and mars the possibility of learning from mistakes? (131.1)

26. Compare a healthy conscience with neurotic self-accusation. (131.2–132.1)

Healthy conscience

- Vigilantly guards best interest of true self
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Neurotic self-accusation

- Stems from neurotic pride, attacks true self
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27. What is meant by “self-contempt”? (132.2)

28. What is self-contempt mainly directed against? (132.2)

29. What are the four consequences of self-contempt? (133.3–137)

- A.
- B.
- C.
- D.

30. Compare healthy self-discipline, or voluntary renunciation, with self-frustration. (140.4–141.3)

Self-discipline/Voluntary Renunciation

- Will forego activities or satisfactions
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Self-frustration

- Wishes are really compulsive needs
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31. Do you experience these or other taboos? Which ones? (141.4–145.2)
32. What is in part an inevitable by-product of self-hate? (145.3)
33. In which of these or other ways do you torture yourself? (145.8)
34. Self-hate finally culminates in what? (148.3)
35. What are some of the ways in which you self-destruct? (148–151.2)
36. What does the patient keep trying to make others do? (151.2)
37. Toward what do self-destructive people silently, but actively, collaborate? (151.3)
38. What is perhaps the greatest tragedy of the human mind? (154.2)
39. Read **Romans 7:14–8:2**. What does Paul offer as the solution to the human struggle with self-hate?

¹ This reading guide refers to the 1991 edition of *Neurosis and Human Growth: The Struggle Toward Self-Realization* by Karen Horney, published by W.W. Norton and Company Inc. New York.